

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 4

♥ 10 5

♦ J 10 9 3 2

♣ Q 7 4

♠ 9 7 3

♥ K J 8 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 10 3



♠ A Q 10 2

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ A Q 9 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ A J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Using elimination plays makes you a better player. But in Bridge, no matter how skillful you are, there will always be a luck factor.

Here you were lucky the defense didn't start by taking their three ♠s. If they had, you would not have been able to pull off the throw-in, and would have had to try your luck with guessing who had the ♣Q.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦J.

With three unavoidable ♠ losers you cannot afford to lose a ♣. So you either have to guess the location of the ♣Q or (DRUMROLL) pull off an elimination play! Win the ♦K, then pull trumps, it takes two rounds.

Next you eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦A then ruffing the ♦8.

Execute the throw-in by leading a ♠.

The defense is in with a ♠ and they are welcome to take two more ♠s. But then they will have to play a ♠ or a ♦, giving you a ruff-sluff, or else lead a ♣ which finds the ♣Q for you.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 3
 ♥ A 9 6 5
 ♦ J 10 8 7
 ♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 9 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ K J 10 3



♠ 10
 ♥ K J 8 3 2
 ♦ A 5 4 2
 ♣ 9 7 4

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 3

♣ A 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

If East is the one who has to play a ♣ you just let it ride around to dummy's ♣ K J 10 3.

If West is the one who has to play a ♣ you need to insert the ♣ 10 or ♣ J from dummy.

In either case you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ J, covered by the ♦ Q and ♦ A. East returns a ♦ to the ♦ K.

You still have two losers in the ♥ suit, so the question is which way you plan to finesse the ♣s. And of course the answer is that you don't plan to finesse them at all!

Pull trumps with the ♠ A, then ♠ K. Next ruff dummy's last ♦.

Now exit with a ♥. The defenders win this and take another ♥ trick, leaving this position.

They must now break the ♣ suit for you or give you a ruff-sluff. Of course you would ruff in dummy and discard a ♣ from the 3-card holding in your hand.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ J 9 8 3
 ♦ Q J 9 7 4
 ♣ Q 8 5 3

♠ 10 6 4 3 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ K 8

♣ K 10 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9
 ♥ Q 10 7 6
 ♦ 10 5 2
 ♣ 9 6 4

♠ A K 8 7 5

♥ A 4

♦ A 6 3

♣ A J 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠

All Pass
 6 ♠ by South
 in dummy.

North decides a limit raise is better than just jumping to game. South has heard enough and bids the slam.

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Your first thought is probably that if you can guess the ♣ Q you will make all thirteen tricks.

So you win the ♦ K and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. When West discards a ♦ your second thought is probably that you **MUST** guess the ♣ Q just to make twelve tricks.

Hopefully your third thought is that if you use an elimination play you won't have to guess.

Play your ♠ A, leaving East with the master ♠ Q. Then eliminate ♦ s by playing ♦ A and ruffing a ♦

Now eliminate ♥ s by playing ♥ A, ♥ K, and ruffing a ♥.

You are ready for the throw-in. Play a ♠ to East's ♠ Q.

[showcards N:ST,CK,CT,C2 S:S8,CA,CJ,C7]

East has just taken the defender's first trick. First and only. Because if he now plays a red card you will ruff in one hand and discard a losing ♣ from the other. And if he plays a ♣ you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

Most elimination plays work on the same principle. The biggest difference is usually the technique you have to use to complete the eliminations.

Here it took two ruffs, one in each hand.